



General Assembly

February Session, 2026

Raised Bill No. 236

LCO No. 1517



Referred to Committee on TRANSPORTATION

Introduced by:
(TRA)

***AN ACT IMPLEMENTING THE RECOMMENDATIONS OF THE
CONNECTICUT AIRPORT AUTHORITY REGARDING THE LICENSURE
AND REGISTRATION OF AIRPORTS AND OTHER AIR NAVIGATION
FACILITIES.***

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Assembly convened:

1 Section 1. Section 13b-46 of the general statutes is repealed and the
2 following is substituted in lieu thereof (*Effective October 1, 2026*):

3 (a) The executive director may approve airports, heliports, vertiports,
4 restricted landing areas and other air navigation facilities. Any
5 municipality or person acquiring property for the purpose of
6 constructing or establishing an airport, heliport, vertiport or restricted
7 landing area shall, prior to such acquisition, apply to the executive
8 director for a certificate of approval of the site selected and the general
9 purpose or purposes for which the property is to be acquired, to ensure
10 that the property and its use shall conform to minimum standards of
11 safety and shall serve the public interest. Any proposed airport,
12 heliport, vertiport, restricted landing area or other air navigation facility
13 at which more than thirty-six landings and takeoffs are expected to be
14 made by aircraft in any year shall be approved by the executive director

15 before it shall be licensed to be used or operated. The executive director
 16 shall make no charge for approval certificates of proposed property
 17 acquisition for airport, heliport, vertiport or restricted landing area
 18 purposes.

19 (b) The executive director may (1) license airports, heliports,
 20 vertiports, restricted landing areas and other air navigation facilities at
 21 which more than thirty-six landings and takeoffs are expected to be
 22 made by aircraft in any year, and (2) renew such licenses. When a
 23 certificate of approval of an airport, heliport, vertiport, [or] restricted
 24 landing area or other air navigation facility has been issued by the
 25 executive director, the executive director may grant a license for
 26 operation and use. On and after [July 1, 1995] October 1, 2026, the
 27 executive director shall charge a fee of [one hundred fifty] three
 28 hundred dollars for each license or renewal thereof. Each such license
 29 shall be effective for a period of three years from the date of issuance.
 30 Each licensee shall certify, on a form provided by the executive director,
 31 that the licensed facility shall comply with all applicable federal, state
 32 and local laws and regulations during the license period. Municipalities
 33 shall be exempt from the payment of any license fee in connection with
 34 airports owned or operated by such municipalities.

35 (c) The executive director may (1) register any airport, heliport,
 36 vertiport, restricted landing area or other air navigation facility at which
 37 thirty-six or fewer landings and takeoffs are expected to be made by
 38 aircraft in any year, and (2) renew such registrations. On and after
 39 October 1, 2026, the executive director shall charge a fee of one hundred
 40 dollars for each registration or renewal thereof. Each such registration
 41 shall be effective for a period of three years from the date of issuance.
 42 Each registrant shall certify, on a form provided by the executive
 43 director, (A) that the registered facility shall comply with all applicable
 44 federal, state and local laws and regulations during the registration
 45 period, and (B) that there will be thirty-six or fewer landings and
 46 takeoffs by aircraft at such facility in any year during the registration
 47 period. Any airport, heliport, vertiport, restricted landing area or other

48 air navigation facility at which thirty-six or fewer landings and takeoffs
 49 are expected to be made by aircraft in any year shall be registered with
 50 the executive director pursuant to this subsection before it is to be used
 51 or operated. Municipalities shall be exempt from the payment of any
 52 registration fee in connection with airports owned or operated by such
 53 municipalities.

54 ~~[(c)]~~ (d) No municipality or officer or employee thereof and no person
 55 shall operate an airport, heliport, vertiport, restricted landing area or
 56 other air navigation facility for which approval has not been granted,
 57 and a license has not been issued by the executive director in accordance
 58 with the provisions of subsection (b) of this section or registration was
 59 not made in accordance with the provisions of subsection (c) of this
 60 section. The provisions of this section shall not apply to any airport,
 61 heliport, vertiport, restricted landing area or other air navigation facility
 62 owned by the federal government within this state. Any person who
 63 violates this subsection shall be guilty of a class C misdemeanor.

64 ~~[(d)]~~ (e) Any heliport in operation prior to October 1, 1985, shall be
 65 deemed licensed for operation and use and the executive director shall
 66 issue an original license for any such heliport upon the written request
 67 of the person who controls and operates such heliport. Such heliports
 68 shall be subject to the provisions of this chapter concerning the renewal
 69 or revocation of licenses, inspection and review of air navigation
 70 facilities and any other provision of this chapter except those concerning
 71 the initial approval or licensing of such facilities. Such heliports shall be
 72 subject to any rule or procedure adopted by the authority in accordance
 73 with the provisions of this chapter except those concerning the initial
 74 approval or licensing of any air navigation facility.

75 Sec. 2. Subsection (a) of section 13b-50p of the general statutes is
 76 repealed and the following is substituted in lieu thereof (*Effective October*
 77 *1, 2026*):

78 (a) The executive director of the Connecticut Airport Authority, upon

79 receipt of a written complaint, in such form and containing such
80 information as the executive director may require, from any person
81 alleging that there have been repeated landings or takeoffs by aircraft
82 from any real property not licensed or registered as an airport, heliport,
83 vertiport, restricted landing area or other air navigation facility under
84 the provisions of section 13b-46, as amended by this act, may require the
85 owner of such property to keep records of all landings and takeoffs
86 made by aircraft from such property for a period of one year. Upon
87 receipt of such records, the executive director shall, within ten days,
88 forward such records to the chief elected official of the municipality in
89 which such area or facility is located. The provisions of this subsection
90 shall not apply to any landing or takeoff made by military aircraft or an
91 emergency medical service organization, any landing made for
92 emergency purposes or any landing or takeoff made at an annual special
93 event or for agricultural purposes.

This act shall take effect as follows and shall amend the following sections:		
Section 1	October 1, 2026	13b-46
Sec. 2	October 1, 2026	13b-50p(a)

Statement of Purpose:

To implement the recommendations of the Connecticut Airport Authority regarding the licensure and registration of airports and other air navigation facilities.

[Proposed deletions are enclosed in brackets. Proposed additions are indicated by underline, except that when the entire text of a bill or resolution or a section of a bill or resolution is new, it is not underlined.]